ELECTRIFIED Comfort

MARUTI SUZUKI IS TRYING TO MOBILISE INDIA AGAIN THROUGH AN ELECTRIC CAR. BUT JUST HOW CAPABLE IS IT? WE FIND OUT

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Decades back, Maruti Suzuki revolutionised Indian mobility by launching a small car called the Maruti 800. The 800 was a game changer because it introduced Indians to such novel concepts as reliability, authorised service stations and, even, fuel economy. Now, the company wants to do it again with electric mobility and is coming out with a tag line which says, "Wherever you go, you are never far away from a Maruti Suzuki charging station". Interesting right? But what about the e Vitara? Is it going to be the new age Maruti Suzuki 800? Let's find out.

The e Vitara belongs to the family of EVs that look very conventional. Maruti Suzuki calls it a Polyhedral Muscular Stance and we call it just apt for a SUV that fits into traffic seamlessly. The front end comes with LED Daytime Running Lights and headlamps, and there is an adaptive grille below. The bonnet comes with bulges that add aggression to the design. One can spot the flared wheel arches and claddings that give it the SUV look. The 18 inch alloy wheels, too, fill the wheel wells proportionately. At the back there is the LED-connected tail light panel and e Vitara badging sitting prominently on the boot lid. Note carefully and one can see the sweeping spoiler on the roof.

As for dimensions, the e Vitara is 4,275 mm long, 1,800 mm wide and sits tall at 1,640 mm. The wheelbase, too, is substantial at 2,700 mm. Ground clearance is 185 mm and that is plenty. The vehicle is big enough to take on the likes of the Hyundai Creta Electric.

The interiors of the e Vitara are draped in dual tone shades and